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Java SE 27 & JDK 27

Class Formatter

java.lang.Object
    java.util.logging.Formatter

Direct Known Subclasses:

SimpleFormatter, XMLFormatter

```
public abstract class Formatter
extends Object
```

A Formatter provides support for formatting LogRecords.

Typically each logging Handler will have a Formatter associated with it. The Formatter takes a LogRecord and converts it to a string.

Some formatters (such as the XMLFormatter) need to wrap head and tail strings around a set of formatted records. The getHeader and getTail methods can be used to obtain these strings.

Since:

1.4

Constructor Summary

Constructors

Modifier	Constructor	Description
protected	**Formatter**()	Construct a new formatter.

Method Summary

All Methods | **Instance Methods**

Modifier and Type	Method	Description
abstract String	**format**(LogRecord record)	Format the given log record and return the formatted string.
String	**formatMessage**(LogRecord record)	Localize and format the message string from a log record.
String	**getHead**(Handler h)	

		Return the header string for a set of formatted records.
String	**getTail**(Handler h)	Return the tail string for a set of formatted records.

Methods declared in class Object

clone, equals, finalize, getClass, hashCode, notify, notifyAll, toString, wait, wait, wait

Constructor Details

Formatter

```
protected Formatter()
```

Construct a new formatter.

Method Details

format

```
public abstract String format(LogRecord record)
```

Format the given log record and return the formatted string.

The resulting formatted String will normally include a localized and formatted version of the LogRecord's message field. It is recommended to use the `formatMessage(LogRecord)` convenience method to localize and format the message field.

Parameters:

`record` - the log record to be formatted.

Returns:

the formatted log record

getHead

```
public String getHead(Handler h)
```

Return the header string for a set of formatted records.

This base class returns an empty string, but this may be overridden by subclasses.

Parameters:

`h` - The target handler (can be null)

Returns:

header string

getTail

```
public String getTail(Handler h)
```

Return the tail string for a set of formatted records.

This base class returns an empty string, but this may be overridden by subclasses.

Parameters:

`h` - The target handler (can be null)

Returns:

tail string

formatMessage

```
public String formatMessage(LogRecord record)
```

Localize and format the message string from a log record. This method is provided as a convenience for Formatter subclasses to use when they are performing formatting.

The message string is first localized to a format string using the record's ResourceBundle. (If there is no ResourceBundle, or if the message key is not found, then the key is used as the format string.) The format String uses java.text style formatting.

- If there are no parameters, no formatter is used.
- Otherwise, if the string contains "{<digit>" where <digit> is in [0-9], java.text.MessageFormat is used to format the string.
- Otherwise no formatting is performed.

Parameters:

`record` - the log record containing the raw message

Returns:

a localized and formatted message

Report a bug or suggest an enhancement
For further API reference and developer documentation see the Java SE Documentation, which contains more detailed, developer-targeted descriptions with conceptual overviews, definitions of terms, workarounds, and working code examples. Other versions.
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